SARBANANDA SONOWAL
Union Minister of Ports, Shipping and Waterways



KEY TAKEAWAYS

- The Sagarmala Programme is more than a port development initiative—it is driving economic expansion by integrating industrial clusters, economic zones
- With 49 per cent government participation in the Maritime Development Fund, India is inviting global investors to accelerate port modernisation
- Plans to unify major rivers like the Ganga and Brahmaputra into an inland water transport network will bring economic benefits to remote areas
- Drawing on India's maritime legacy, the government has positioned port development as a step towards reclaiming India's status as a global shipping leader

INDIA TODAY INFRASTRUCTURE CONCLAVE

PUTTING INDIA ON FAST TRACK

The India Today Infrastructure Conclave deliberated on India's achievements in various sectors and looked at the challenges ahead, with the spotlight on aviation, ports, sustainable infrastructure and financing

Photographs by **RAJWANT RAWAT**